Conversation track 22, 24, 25

Lorna has a funny story to tell Rupert about last night.

Rupert: Come on, you've been giggling all morning. What's the story?

Lorna: **You'll never guess** what I did at the conference dinner last night.

Rupert: Go on. Did you fall asleep during a speech?

Lorna: Worse. **So there I am**, asking this guy in a suit for more bread.

Rupert: As you do.

Lorna: Well, I thought he was a waiter! Then, **get this**, they call him up on stage.

Rupert: Oh no. Don't tell me he was the keynote speaker.

Lorna: Yep. And he started his talk with a joke about it.

Rupert: He didn't! What did you do?

Lorna: **Long story short**, I'm never asking anyone for bread again.

Speak Like a Native track 23

1. Then, get this, they call him up on stage.

strong: "get this", "stage"
linking: "call‿him‿up"

"get this" (nghe này) tách riêng, ngắt trước và sau để tạo hồi hộp. "him" mất h, nối thành "ca-li-mấp".

2. Don't tell me he was the keynote speaker.

linking: "Don't‿tell"
strong: "keynote speaker"

Đoán trước điều tệ, giọng lo lắng. Hai âm t gộp làm một: "đâun-tel". Giọng Anh thường không đọc r cuối: /ˈspiːkə/.

3. Long story short, I'm never asking anyone for bread again.

strong: "never", "bread"
weak: "for"

Ngắt sau "Long story short", rồi nói chậm lại ở câu chốt; nhấn "never" và "bread" để gây cười.

- "So there I am…" đọc chậm, hơi kéo dài "So", rồi ngắt nhẹ để người nghe hình dung cảnh.
- "You'll never guess…", "get this" báo hiệu chuyện bất ngờ: nói chậm, rõ, ngắt sau đó.
- Câu chốt (punchline) nói chậm, xuống giọng, rồi dừng để người nghe cười.
- Đại từ him, her, his đọc nhẹ thường mất h: call him up → "ca-li-mấp".

Role Play track 27

A: Come on, you've been giggling all morning. What's the story?

B: You'll never guess _____ at the conference dinner last night.

A: Go on. Did you fall asleep during a speech?

B: Worse. So there I am, asking this guy in a suit for _____.

A: As you do.

B: Well, I thought he was a waiter! Then, get this, they call him up on stage.

A: Oh no. Don't tell me he was the keynote speaker.

B: Yep. And he started his talk with a joke about it.

A: He didn't! What did you do?

B: _____, I'm never asking anyone for bread again.

Study Notes

As you do.
Chuyện thường ngày ấy mà (nói đùa).
Câu đùa tỉnh bơ của người Anh: giả vờ coi một việc kỳ quặc là chuyện hết sức bình thường.
Cách nói tương đương: As one does.

He didn't!
Không thể nào!
Đáp bằng trợ động từ ở thể phủ định, xuống giọng mạnh, để tỏ ý không tin nổi (nửa sốc, nửa buồn cười).
Cách nói tương đương: No way!

Grammar Focus

Mở đầu và dựng cảnh: You'll never guess… / So there I am…

Báo hiệu sắp kể chuyện bất ngờ, rồi dùng thì hiện tại để đưa người nghe vào cảnh như đang xảy ra.

You'll never guess who I bumped into today.
So there I am, standing in the rain with no keys.
And get this, the car wasn't even ours.

Kết chuyện: Long story short… / Anyway, the point is…

Rút gọn phần dài dòng để đi thẳng đến kết quả hoặc câu chốt. Người Anh hay nói To cut a long story short.

Long story short, we missed the flight.
To cut a long story short, they got married.
Anyway, the point is, always check the date.

Substitution Drill track 28

1. You'll never guess **what I did** at the conference dinner last night.
   a. who I met
   b. what happened
   c. who I sat next to

2. So there I am, asking this guy in a suit for **more bread**.
   a. a glass of water
   b. the dessert menu
   c. another coffee

3. **Long story short**, I'm never asking anyone for bread again.
   a. To cut a long story short
   b. Needless to say
   c. Anyway